Blommer CHOCOLATE COMPANY

East Greenville, PA • Chicago, IL • Union City, CA• Campbellford, ON

Memo To: Our Valued Customers

From: Blommer Chocolate Company

Date: January 2024

Re: GM / BE Status of Sugar for Blommer Plants

Genetically Modified - BE Disclosure
Blommer Sugar Statement

The following document has been prepared to better answer questions and defines Blommer Chocolate's position in regard to Genetic Modification (GMs) and BE disclosure in sugars and usage at our various manufacturing plants.

Nearly all sugar beet growers across the USA plant the genetically modified Round-Up ready variety of seed. Favorable yields and sucrose content were reported from most of the growers using this new variety. As a direct result, the industry has seen widespread adoption of the new variety. The industry generally considers that if sugar is sourced from a beet refinery it is generally considered genetically modified.

We have heard from our suppliers that research has been undertaken to produce cane sugar from GM sugarcane stock. The sugar is identical to sugar produced from conventional sugarcane which is considered nonGM. The sugar contains no protein or DNA from the GM plant. This may impact supply and cost in the near future.

Campbellford – 100% non-GM sugar. Sugar is derived from sugarcane. There could be changes to supply chain later this year (2024) in the event genetically modified strains of sugarcane become more prevalent in the industry.

East Greenville – 100% non-GM sugar. Sugar is derived from sugarcane. We may begin seeing an industry trend commanding a premium for nonGM sugar.

Union City – Is currently receiving sugar from both nonGM cane and GM sugar beet derived sugar sources into common bulk handling silos and system. However, Union City retains the ability to segregate and provide products in certain applications using Non-GM sugar. Product premiums will apply to those customers requiring nonGM sugar in Union City for separate handling and segregation.

Chicago – Is currently receiving sugar from GM sugar beet derived sugar sources. However, Chicago retains the ability to segregate and provide products in certain, special applications from Non-GM sugar. Product premiums will apply to those customers requiring nonGM sugar in Chicago for separate handling and segregation.

Sugars used by Blommer do not require BE disclosure as they are confirmed as highly refined.

If you have further questions, please check with your Blommer Sales Representative.